

The OnePlus Nord 5 takes a different approach. Instead of trying to stand out visually, it focuses on a clean design. The matte glass finish feels smooth in the hand and does a better job of hiding smudges and fingerprints.

Both phones follow a flat-sided design language, so they feel quite similar when held. Buttons are also quite tactile and clicky on both devices, offering satisfying response.

The Nord 5 tends to wobble a lot on a flat surface. To solve this, you can use a phone back cover. On the other hand, Phone 4a sits flat without rocking.

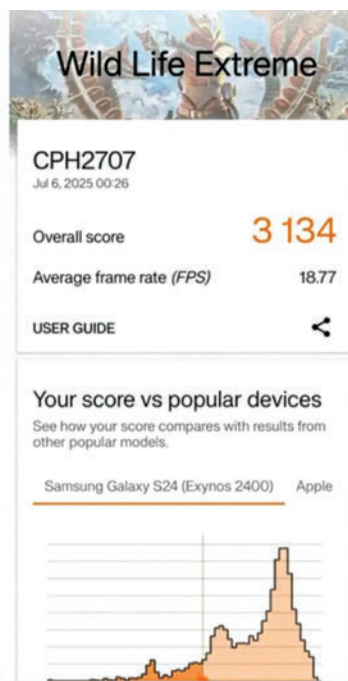
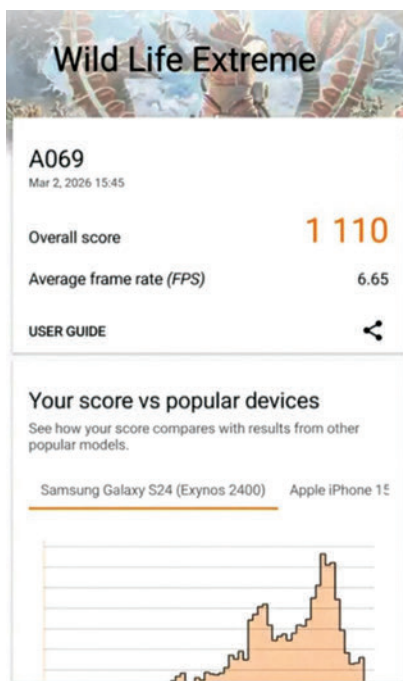
Both devices include stereo speakers with strong output, and OnePlus adds an IR blaster, which can be useful for controlling your home appliances.

Display

When it comes to the displays, both the Nothing Phone 4a and Nord 5 use LTPS AMOLED panels. The Phone 4a has a 120Hz 6.78-inch screen, while the Nord 5 has a slightly larger 6.83-inch screen with a smoother 144Hz refresh rate. In terms of quality, both are quite vibrant and smooth. However, the tuning between them is slightly different.

Scrolling through apps and navigating the interface feels fluid on both devices, although the higher refresh rate on the Nord 5 does give it a slight edge in terms of responsiveness. At the same time, Nothing's software animations are very well tuned, which helps the Phone 4a feel polished during everyday use.

The displays also ran through our Digit Test Labs, and when we looked at the numbers from our display testing, the Nord 5 achieved stronger results in colour accuracy. In the Calman colour



test, the Phone 4a recorded an average Delta E of 2.4, which is okay. The Nord 5, however, achieved an impressive average Delta E of 0.6.

Both displays perform well in colour gamut coverage. The Phone 4a reached 99.9% in the colour gamut test, while the Nord 5 measured 100%.

Brightness is where the results shift slightly because the Nothing Phone 4a peaked at 2,640 nits in our testing, which made it easier to see outdoors under harsh sunlight. The Nord 5 measured around 1,560 nits, and it is still usable outside, but reflections were more noticeable.

When watching HDR content, both displays look good. Colours appear vibrant, contrast is strong, and viewing angles are excellent. If you put the phones side by side, the Nord 5 looks a bit more vivid and brighter, but the Phone 4a retains slightly better detail in darker scenes.

Camera

The camera hardware between these two phones takes noticeably different approaches. The Nothing Phone 4a includes a triple-camera setup that

comes with a 50MP main camera, an 8MP ultra-wide sensor and a dedicated 50MP telephoto camera. The OnePlus Nord 5 relies on a dual-camera setup with a 50MP main sensor and an 8MP ultrawide lens.

In daylight photography, both devices capture good images, but the Nothing Phone 4a tends to produce slightly more vibrant colours, while the Nord 5 aims for a more natural look.

One thing that stood out during my testing was how the Nord 5 often adds a

blue tint to the sky.

Portrait photography is where the dedicated telephoto lens on the Phone 4a makes a difference. The phone captures portraits with cleaner background blur and noticeably better edge detection. Hair strands and subject outlines are handled better compared to the Nord 5.

The ultra-wide camera also performs slightly better on the Phone 4a, capturing more detail and maintaining better consistency with the main camera.

For selfies, the Phone 4a uses a 32MP front camera while the Nord 5 offers a 50MP sensor. The Nord 5 captures more detail, but the overall colour processing on the Phone 4a produces better results, especially in portrait selfies.

On the video side, the Nothing Phone 4a supports recording 4K at 30fps, while the OnePlus Nord 5 can record at 4K 60fps. **d**

